

WISEIQ

wiseiq.net

---

# Credit Repair Action Kit

Your Complete 90-Day Roadmap to a Higher Score

Dispute letters · 90-day action plan · Score tracker

A WiseIQ Digital Resource

wiseiq.net | For educational purposes only

**Disclaimer:** This kit is for educational purposes only and does not constitute legal or financial advice. WiseIQ is not a credit repair organization. You have the right to dispute inaccurate information on your credit report for free — you do not need to pay anyone to do this for you.

## How to Use This Kit

This kit contains three parts: **Part 1** is a week-by-week 90-day action plan to systematically improve your credit score. **Part 2** contains ready-to-customize dispute letter templates for the most common credit errors. **Part 3** is a monthly tracking system to measure your progress. Work through Part 1 first. Use Part 2 only when you find errors. Use Part 3 every single month.

### PART 1 — THE 90-DAY CREDIT REPAIR ACTION PLAN

## Before You Start: The Five Numbers That Control Your Score

Your credit score is calculated from five specific factors, each weighted differently. Knowing these weights tells you exactly where to focus your energy.

| Factor                   | Weight | What It Measures                                    |
|--------------------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Payment History          | 35%    | Whether you pay on time, every time                 |
| Credit Utilization       | 30%    | How much of your available credit you are using     |
| Length of Credit History | 15%    | How long your accounts have been open               |
| Credit Mix               | 10%    | Whether you have revolving and installment accounts |
| New Credit               | 10%    | New accounts or hard inquiries                      |

**The single most important insight in this kit:** Payment history and utilization together make up 65% of your score. If you do nothing else, focus on paying on time and keeping your balances low. Everything else is secondary.

## The Hidden Utilization Rule Nobody Tells You

Your credit report does not show your balance on the day you pay. It shows your balance on the **statement closing date** — the day your card issuer generates your monthly statement, typically 21 days before your payment due date.

If you pay your balance in full every month but your statement closes with a \$2,000 balance on a \$3,000 limit card, your reported utilization is 67% — even though you owe nothing the day after you pay. The bureaus

see the statement balance, not the payment.

**The fix:** Pay your balance down to below 10% of your limit *before* your statement closing date, not just before the due date. This one change can add 20–50 points to your score within 30 days.

## Days 1–7: Audit Your Credit Reports

Go to **AnnualCreditReport.com** — the only federally mandated free source. Pull all three reports (Equifax, Experian, TransUnion). They are often different because not all creditors report to all three bureaus. Since 2020, weekly free reports have been available.

### Common Errors to Look For

| Error Type     | What to Look For                                                                        |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Personal Info  | Wrong name, address, SSN digits, or date of birth                                       |
| Account Errors | Accounts you don't recognize; wrong credit limit (lowers your utilization artificially) |
| Status Errors  | Open accounts reported as closed; "closed by grantor" vs. "closed by consumer"          |
| Late Payments  | Payments shown as late when you have proof they were on time                            |
| Collections    | Same debt listed twice (original creditor + collector)                                  |
| Re-Aged Debt   | Negative items past the 7-year limit from date of first delinquency                     |
| Bankruptcy     | Chapter 7 beyond 10 years; Chapter 13 beyond 7 years                                    |

## Days 8–21: Dispute Inaccurate Items

Always dispute by mail with certified mail and return receipt — never online. This creates a paper trail, gives you documentation if you need to escalate to the CFPB, and preserves your legal rights. Send disputes to each bureau separately.

| Bureau     | Dispute Mailing Address                                                   |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Equifax    | Equifax Information Services LLC, P.O. Box 740256, Atlanta, GA 30374-0256 |
| Experian   | Experian, P.O. Box 4500, Allen, TX 75013                                  |
| TransUnion | TransUnion LLC Consumer Dispute Center, P.O. Box 2000, Chester, PA 19016  |

**If your dispute comes back "verified":** This does not mean the information is correct — it often means the creditor confirmed it without reviewing your documentation. You can re-dispute with additional evidence, add a 100-word consumer statement to your file, file a complaint with the CFPB at ConsumerFinance.gov, or consult a consumer law attorney (many work on contingency for FCRA violations).

## Days 22–45: Attack Your Utilization

Utilization changes are reflected in your score within 30–45 days of your creditor reporting your new balance — making this the fastest lever available to you.

### The 30-10-1 Rule

| Target               | Rule           | Why It Matters                                                    |
|----------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total utilization    | Below 30%      | Minimum threshold — anything above hurts your score significantly |
| Per-card utilization | Below 10%      | Where the real score gains accelerate                             |
| At least one card    | At 1% (not 0%) | A card never used contributes less than one with a tiny balance   |

### Strategies to Lower Utilization Without Paying Off Debt

- **Request a credit limit increase** without a hard inquiry. If your limit goes from \$3,000 to \$5,000 and your balance stays at \$1,500, your utilization drops from 50% to 30% instantly.
- **Spread balances across cards.** Moving debt from a maxed card to a card with available credit lowers per-card utilization even when total debt stays the same.
- **Become an authorized user** on a family member's long-standing, low-utilization card. Their account history and available credit gets added to your report.

## Days 46–60: Protect Your Payment History

One 30-day late payment can drop your score by 60–110 points and stays on your report for 7 years. Set autopay for the **statement balance** (not the minimum) to pay in full every month. If you cannot afford the full balance, set autopay for the minimum as a safety net and pay more manually.

### Dealing with Collections

**Do not pay a collection account without negotiating first.** Paying a collection does not remove it from your report — it just changes the status from "unpaid" to "paid collection." Both hurt your score. Before paying, send a debt validation letter (template in Part 2), then negotiate a pay-for-delete agreement in writing before sending any payment.

## Days 61–90: Build for the Long Term

Freeze your credit at all three bureaus if you are not actively applying for credit. A freeze is free, does not affect your score, and prevents identity thieves from opening accounts in your name. Also freeze at ChexSystems (bank accounts) and NCTUE (utility accounts).

| Bureau     | Freeze URL                                                                                                    |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Equifax    | <a href="https://equifax.com/personal/credit-report-services">equifax.com/personal/credit-report-services</a> |
| Experian   | <a href="https://experian.com/freeze/center.html">experian.com/freeze/center.html</a>                         |
| TransUnion | <a href="https://transunion.com/credit-freeze">transunion.com/credit-freeze</a>                               |

### 90-DAY MILESTONE CHECKLIST

| Week    | Action                                                          | Done? |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Week 1  | Pull all 3 credit reports from AnnualCreditReport.com           | ■     |
| Week 1  | Create error log with all inaccuracies found                    | ■     |
| Week 2  | Write and mail dispute letters via certified mail               | ■     |
| Week 2  | Set up autopay on all accounts                                  | ■     |
| Week 3  | Calculate current utilization on each card                      | ■     |
| Week 3  | Pay down highest-utilization card before statement closing date | ■     |
| Week 4  | Follow up on dispute responses (30-day window)                  | ■     |
| Week 5  | Request credit limit increases on existing cards                | ■     |
| Week 6  | Review authorized user opportunities                            | ■     |
| Week 7  | Write goodwill letters for isolated late payments               | ■     |
| Week 8  | Send debt validation letters for any collections                | ■     |
| Week 9  | Negotiate pay-for-delete on verified collections                | ■     |
| Week 10 | Freeze credit at all three bureaus                              | ■     |
| Week 11 | Set up free credit monitoring                                   | ■     |
| Week 12 | Pull updated reports and compare to baseline                    | ■     |

## PART 2 — DISPUTE LETTER TEMPLATES

**How to use these templates:** Replace all text in [brackets] with your specific information. Print on plain paper. Sign in ink. Send via USPS Certified Mail with Return Receipt Requested. Keep a copy of everything you send.

## Letter 1: General Credit Report Error Dispute

[Your Full Name]

[Your Street Address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Your Phone Number]

[Your Email Address]

[Date]

[Bureau Name] — Consumer Dispute Department

[Bureau Address]

Re: Dispute of Inaccurate Information — [Your Full Name] — SSN: XXX-XX-[Last 4 Digits]

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing to dispute the following inaccurate information on my credit report. I have enclosed a copy of my credit report with the disputed item(s) highlighted.

Disputed Item:

- Creditor Name: [Name of Creditor]
- Account Number: [Full or partial account number]
- What the report states: [Describe what the report says]
- What it should state: [Describe the correct information]

This information is inaccurate because [briefly explain the error — e.g., "this account does not belong to me," "this payment was made on time as shown by the enclosed bank statement"].

I am requesting that you investigate this matter and correct or remove the inaccurate information as required under the Fair Credit Reporting Act, 15 U.S.C. § 1681i.

Enclosed documentation:

- Copy of my credit report with disputed item highlighted
- [List any supporting documents]

- Copy of government-issued photo ID
- Copy of Social Security card or utility bill confirming my address

Please send me written confirmation of the results of your investigation within the timeframe required by law.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]

[Your Printed Name]

## Letter 2: Debt Validation Request

Send this to the collection agency — not the credit bureau — within 30 days of their first contact. Under the FDCPA, they must cease collection activity until they validate the debt.

[Your Full Name]

[Your Street Address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Date]

[Collection Agency Name]

[Collection Agency Address]

Re: Request for Debt Validation — Account Number [Account Number]

To Whom It May Concern:

I recently received a communication from your agency regarding an alleged debt. Under the Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA), 15 U.S.C. § 1692g, I have the right to request validation of this debt within 30 days of your initial contact.

I am hereby requesting that you provide me with the following:

1. The name and address of the original creditor
2. The amount of the alleged debt, including an itemized breakdown
3. A copy of the original signed agreement creating the alleged debt
4. Proof that your agency is licensed to collect debts in the state of [Your State]
5. Proof that the statute of limitations has not expired on this debt
6. Documentation showing the complete chain of ownership of this debt

Until this debt is validated, please cease all collection activity, including reporting to credit bureaus.

Do not contact me by phone. All future communications must be in writing to the address above.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]

[Your Printed Name]

## Letter 3: Goodwill Adjustment Request

Use this for a single late payment on an otherwise clean account. Works best when you have been a customer for 2+ years, the late payment was isolated, and you have a legitimate reason.

[Your Full Name]

[Your Street Address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Date]

[Creditor Name] — Customer Relations Department

[Creditor Address]

Re: Goodwill Adjustment Request — Account Number [Your Account Number]

Dear [Creditor Name] Customer Relations Team,

I am writing to respectfully request a goodwill adjustment to remove a late payment from my credit report. I have been a customer since [year] and have consistently paid on time, with the exception of the [month/year] payment.

The late payment occurred because [briefly describe the reason — e.g., "I was unexpectedly hospitalized," "I experienced a temporary job loss," "I was going through a family emergency"]. This was an isolated incident and does not reflect my typical payment behavior.

Since that time, I have [describe your positive history — e.g., "paid every statement on time," "set up automatic payments to ensure this never happens again"].

I understand that you are not obligated to honor this request, and I am not disputing the accuracy of the late payment. I am simply asking for a one-time courtesy adjustment given my otherwise strong payment history with your company.

Thank you sincerely for your time and consideration.

Respectfully,

[Your Signature]

[Your Printed Name]

[Your Phone Number]

## Letter 4: Pay-for-Delete Negotiation

Never pay a collection without a written pay-for-delete agreement first. Get it on company letterhead before sending any money.

[Your Full Name]

[Your Street Address]

[City, State, ZIP]

[Date]

[Collection Agency Name]

[Collection Agency Address]

Re: Settlement and Deletion Agreement — Account Number [Account Number]

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing regarding the above-referenced account, which your agency is currently reporting to the credit bureaus. I am prepared to resolve this matter, but I am requesting a pay-for-delete agreement as a condition of payment.

Specifically, I am proposing the following:

- I will pay \$[Offer Amount] as full and final settlement of this account
- In exchange, your agency will permanently delete all references to this account from my credit reports at Equifax, Experian, and TransUnion within 30 days of receiving payment

THIS OFFER IS CONTINGENT UPON RECEIVING WRITTEN CONFIRMATION OF THIS AGREEMENT BEFORE ANY PAYMENT IS MADE. I will not send payment without a signed letter on your company letterhead confirming the terms above.

Please respond in writing to the address above. Do not contact me by phone.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]

[Your Printed Name]

## PART 3 — CREDIT SCORE TRACKER

## Monthly Score Log

Pull your credit score from the same source every month on the same day. Track the trend over 3–6 month periods — do not panic about small month-to-month fluctuations.

| Month              | Score | Change | Utilization % | Open Disputes | Notes |
|--------------------|-------|--------|---------------|---------------|-------|
| Month 1 (Baseline) |       | —      |               |               |       |
| Month 2            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 3            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 4            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 5            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 6            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 7            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 8            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 9            |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 10           |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 11           |       |        |               |               |       |
| Month 12           |       |        |               |               |       |

## Credit Score Range Reference

| Score Range | Rating      | What It Means                                                                  |
|-------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 800–850     | Exceptional | Best rates on everything. Lenders compete for your business.                   |
| 740–799     | Very Good   | Near-best rates. Approved for almost everything.                               |
| 670–739     | Good        | Approved for most products. Rates are competitive.                             |
| 580–669     | Fair        | Approved for some products. Rates are higher.                                  |
| 300–579     | Poor        | Limited options. Secured cards and credit-builder loans are your path forward. |

## Utilization Tracker (Per Card)

Track each card separately. Goal: under 10% on each card.

| Card Name | Credit Limit | Current Balance | Utilization % | Target Balance (10 |
|-----------|--------------|-----------------|---------------|--------------------|
|           | \$           | \$              | %             | \$                 |
|           | \$           | \$              | %             | \$                 |
|           | \$           | \$              | %             | \$                 |
|           | \$           | \$              | %             | \$                 |
|           | \$           | \$              | %             | \$                 |
| TOTAL     | \$           | \$              | %             |                    |

**Formula:** Utilization % = (Current Balance ÷ Credit Limit) × 100

## Key Resources

| Resource              | URL                           | Purpose                                      |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Annual Credit Report  | AnnualCreditReport.com        | Free credit reports (all 3 bureaus)          |
| CFPB Complaint Portal | ConsumerFinance.gov/complaint | Report FCRA violations                       |
| FTC Identity Theft    | IdentityTheft.gov             | Report identity theft                        |
| Credit Karma          | creditkarma.com               | Free score monitoring (TransUnion + Equifax) |
| NFCC Counseling       | nfcc.org                      | Free nonprofit credit counseling             |